INTERNATIONAL MARITIME ORGANIZATION

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ASSEMBLY
34th session
Agenda item 11

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Resolution A.1217(34)

adopted on 27 November 2025
(Agenda item 11)

THE INCLUSION AND THE USE OF ARABIC AS A WORKING LANGUAGE OF THE ASSEMBLY

THE ASSEMBLY,

CONSIDERING that the use of several working languages by the Organization represents an enrichment, helps to increase its influence at the international level, and constitutes a method of achieving more easily the objectives laid down in the IMO Convention as well as other IMO treaties,

NOTING the continuous increase in the number of Arabic-speaking countries among the Organization's Members and their participation in various IMO meetings and conferences,

RECOGNIZING that strengthening the use of the Arabic language in IMO would:

.1 promote the objective of parity between the six official and working languages, which is the rule in the United Nations system;

.2 contribute towards the enhancement of multilingualism as set out in Assembly resolution A.1180(33); and

.3 support the effective implementation of IMO instruments and overcome the lack of understanding and interpretation of the mandatory instruments into national and subsidiary legislation as one of the root causes of major areas identified in the IMO Member State Audit Scheme (IMSAS),

HAVING CONSIDERED the recommendations of the Council at its 135th session,

1 DECIDES to include Arabic among the working languages of the Assembly;

2 DECIDES to amend rule 29 of its Rules of Procedure accordingly;

3 REQUESTS the Secretary-General to include in the budget estimates of the Organization for the biennium the required appropriations for the use of Arabic as a working language of the Assembly.